

Calendar Line 2, 5, 6

Case Name: *Valikhani v. FCA US LLC*

Case Number: 24CV454713

Plaintiff has brought the following motions:

- 1) Motion to Overrule Preamble and to Compel Further Responses to Special Interrogatories, Set 1;
- 2) Motion to Overrule Preamble and to Compel Further Responses to Form Interrogatories, Set 1;
- 3) Motion to Overrule Preamble and to Compel Further Responses to Requests for Production, Set 1.

The Court ordered the parties to meet and confer and to file a joint separate statement resolving and/or narrowing the issues in dispute on all three motions by July 23, 2025. (Minutes, 7/16/25; 7/18/25.) That did not occur. The Court orders that all three motions are CONTINUED to September 12, 2025, at 9 a.m. in Department 13. The parties are again ordered to conduct good faith, reasonable and meaningful meet and confers, either in person, by phone or video conference, to try to narrow the issues in these motions. If any issues remain after the meet and confer efforts, which may span several sessions, the parties shall file an updated joint statement no later than August 29, 2025, which shall identify the remaining items in dispute and the reasons why further responses should/should not be compelled.

Failure to comply with this order absent good cause will result in sanctions.

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Calendar Line 4

Case Name: *Rita Gutierrez vs General Motors LLC*

Case No.: 23CV425715

I. INTRODUCTION

On March 28, 2025, Plaintiff in this Song Beverly action (SBA) filed this Motion for Attorney's Fees and Costs, requesting: (1) lodestar fees of \$82,290.00; (2) a multiplier of 1.5-2.0, yielding an additional \$41,145.00-\$82,290.00; and (3) costs of \$8,223.65; for a total sought award between \$123,435.00 and \$164,580.00 in fees, plus \$8,223.65 in costs. (Pl.'s Mot. for Att'y Fees & Costs ("Mot.") 3, 12 (filed Mar. 28, 2025).)

On June 30, 2025, this Court awarded Plaintiff \$5,708.93 in costs. Now, Plaintiff requests the following hourly rates and hours:

Time-keeper	Title	Hourly Rate	Hours	Lodestar	Litigation
Mark O'Connor, Esq.	Senior Partner	\$ 750	21.3 h	\$ 15,975	• Technical case analysis & strategy (review GM warranty & TSB docs, 3-6-24) • Lead settlement negotiations & CCP § 998 revisions (11-20-24 meeting; 12-13-24 offer edits)
Matthew T. Goethals, Esq	Lead Counsel	\$ 500	88.0 h	\$ 44,000	• Draft & revise discovery responses (3-3-24 ROGs/RFAs/RFPs) • Prepare four motions to compel & joint statements (10-17-24) • Assemble attorney-fee motion & billing audit (3-27-25)
Shawna M. Melton, Esq.	Sr. Associate	\$ 650	1.3 h	\$ 845	• Prepare for & attend Case-Mgmt. Conf. (10-15-24)
Luis Aguirre, Esq.	Associate (former)	\$ 475	5.2 h	\$ 2,470	• Draft meet-and-confer letters re deficient discovery (3-5-24 & 3-6-24)
Kristin Arndt	Paralegal	\$ 200	56.3 h	\$ 11,260	• Draft & file discovery/pleading papers (12-20-23 discovery sets) • Finalize joint statement & e-file (10-17-24) • Compile fee exhibits & invoice spreadsheet (3-28-25)